



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
Emergency Communications Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

Title: JCF Emergency Communications Policy and Standard Operating Procedures	Number: JCF/FW/PL/Ops/0001/2022
Effective Date: 2024-June 08	Pages: 30
Review Date: 2024-Jun-06	Distribution: Force Wide
Revision # 1	Process Owners: ACP Operations; PECC
Rescinds: N/A	Accreditation Standards:
Authors: PRDB, JCF	Owner: JCF
First Published: F.O. # 2322 dated 1991-Dec-05	Review: Biennially

Table of Contents

1. Introduction.....	3
2. Purpose.....	4
3. Scope.....	4
4. Abbreviations and Acronyms.....	4
5. Definitions.....	5
6. Responsibilities.....	5
7. Policy Statement	6
8. Standard Operating Procedures.....	6
9. Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles	27
10. Relevant Records and Forms	27
11. Roles and Functions.....	27
Appendix 1 Message Action Diary.....	28

1. Introduction

The Police Emergency Communication Centre formerly Police Control Centre is a mission-critical division of the Jamaica Constabulary Force. It is the Nation's Emergency Communication Hub for security matters; It is the home of 119 as also other forms of emergencies.

The core functions of the Emergency Communication Centre include prompt response to 119 calls and effective and appropriate deployment to emergencies. The Centre also keeps the Police High Command abreast of all significant incidents and occurrences nationally. In the interest of national security, sensitive information is filtered and passed on to the appropriate source for action. Other functions of the Centre include:

- i. Coordination with police operatives in the field.
- ii. Coordination with internal and external stakeholders for effective management of emergencies.
- iii. Coordination of intra and inter-circuit communication of police assets for support and effective response.
- iv. Dissemination of information to operational assets for support, moral boosting and quality assurance, through Proactive and Flash messages.
- v. Collation, dissemination and archiving of information to aid in daily policing activities.
- vi. Provision of information to operational teams from various databases to aid effective crime and social order management.
- vii. Maintenance of accurate records of all communication for investigative reference

The communication system is managed by two (2) separate formations in the organization. (i) The Police Emergency Communication Centre (PECC), Operations Branch who are the process owner and user of the system and (ii) Technology Branch with responsibility to maintain and upgrade the equipment used in the process.

Each formation is responsible to ensure the accuracy, dependability, speed and confidentiality of electronic communication at all levels. The respective commanding officer will ensure that all members of staff under their command (i) contribute effectively to the standardization of services rendered; (ii) ensure the reduction of errors; (iii) aid the training effort; and (iv) reduce confusion during emergency situations.

The Police Emergency Communication Centre operates from four locations as follows;

1. **Headquarters:** Kingston Police Emergency Communication Centre located at 103 Old Hope Road, Kingston 6. It covers, Areas 4 and 5 namely; Kingston, St Andrew, St Catherine and St Thomas.
2. **Area 1:** located at Church Street, Montego Bay, - St. James and covers the divisions of Trelawny, St James, Hanover and Westmoreland.
3. **Area 2:** located at Pompano Bay, St Mary it covers the divisions of Portland, St Mary and St Ann.
4. **Area 3:** located at Area 3 HQs, Mandeville, Manchester covers the parishes of Clarendon, Manchester and St. Elizabeth.

The information flow is facilitated by radio, telephone, computers systems and digital display.

The communication system conveys information between the police and others in the following ways:

- a. From the public to the police station or office requiring law enforcement service
- b. From police station or office to police personnel who respond to the call for assistance
- c. From the police to other public service agencies in time of need and
- d. To information storage and retrieval facilities.

2. Purpose

This document outlines the policy and standard operating procedures for the management of police emergency communication throughout the organization, and formalizes existing guidelines on the communication process.

3. Scope

This Policy and Standard Operating Procedures applies to all sworn and unsworn members of the JCF and its auxiliary. It covers radio, telephone and telefax communication relating to police functions.

4. Abbreviations and Acronyms

JCF	Jamaica Constabulary Force
JDF	Jamaica Defence Force
INTERPOL	International Criminal Police Organization

NWA	National Works Agency
ODPEM	Office of Disaster Preparedness and Emergency Management
PECC	Police Emergency Communication Centre
Telecom	Telecommunications Division
CAD	Computer Aided Dispatched System

5. Definitions

For the purpose of this Policy and Standard Operating Procedure the following definitions shall apply:

5.1 Digital Display - an output device which shows/presents information in visual form on a screen

5.2 Telephone Recorder – a hardware that is used to record telephone message; for example, in the case where the alarm of an establishment is linked to the police station, when the alarm is activated a recorded message is received on the telephone at the station, giving the identity and location of the premises of the establishment.

6. Responsibilities

The following summarizes key responsibilities:

- The Assistant Commissioner of Police i/c Operations has responsibility for the oversight of the PECC
- 6.1** The Assistant Commissioner of Police, Technology Branch is responsible to issue Branch Order specifying standing instructions for the management of equipment in the force's communication programme.
- 6.2** The Superintendent of Police i/c PECC is responsible for the management and daily operations of the PECC and is accountable to the ACP Operations Branch for the effective radio communication islandwide
- 6.3** The Superintendent of Police in charge of the Telecommunications Division is responsible for the effective functioning of technical equipment used in the communication process at the PECC, and is accountable to the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Services Branch.

7. Policy Statement

It is the policy of the JCF that a communication system shall be in effect to satisfy the immediate information needs of the Force in the course of its normal day-to-day activities and during emergencies.

8. Standard Operating Procedures

The management of communications within the JCF shall be treated in accordance with the following procedures:

A. The Police Emergency Communication Centre (PECC)

- I. The PECC is manned on an eight-hour shift basis round the clock under the command of:
 - i. A gazetted officer in charge each shift as far as is practicable reporting to Assistant Commissioner, Operations;
 - ii. A monitor who is second in charge.
- II. The officer in charge PECC will ensure that adequate security measures are in place to prevent unauthorized entry and protect equipment. Entry is limited to authorized persons only. All visitors should have the prior approval of the Officer in charge.
- III. All information received and/or disseminated from the centres shall be dealt with speedily and confidentially.
- IV. To minimize traffic and improve security, the following guidelines will be adhered to:
 - i. The PECC shall be out of bounds to all unauthorized persons;
 - ii. The doors to the PECC will be kept locked at all times;
 - iii. Firearms should not be issued in the PECC. Personnel on security duties will be given directions at the enquires desk;
 - iv. The monitor will arrange for all personnel to take refreshment and meals in the recreational area;
 - v. Senior officers visiting PECC will be briefed in the viewing room save in exceptional cases;

- vi. Briefing of senior officers on activities which have taken place shall be done by the officer in charge PECC or in his absence the monitor;
- vii. In joint police/military operations the senior police officer and the senior military officer shall both occupy the viewing area from which they will direct activities;
- viii. Where the military is otherwise represented at PECC the officer in charge PECC will relate to the military officer on duty;
- ix. The PECC is supervised by a monitor under command of an officer.

B. The Emergency Telephone Lines – 119

- I. It is necessary for citizens to be able to contact police immediately should the need arise. Internationally a three-digit emergency telephone number is used. In Jamaica the emergency police number is 119 and it facilitates quick and easy access to police in times of need on a round-the-clock basis.
- II. When a citizen makes a 119 emergency call it is answered by Call Taker at PECC who will interview the caller and record the information on the Computer Aided Dispatched (CAD) System and if there is a system failure the Message Action Diary Form must be used. The information is then sent to the Dispatcher who then communicates with the relevant unit or station (whether by radio or telephone) conveying the message and requesting appropriate action. All actions and assignments are to be recorded in the CAD or the Message Action Diary Form (**Appendix1**) and brought to the attention of the monitor who will evaluate action taken so far and either refer to the control officer or direct further action as necessary.
- III. At the conclusion of a tour of duty, it is the responsibility of the Monitor being relieved to bring to the attention of the relieving Monitor all Message Action Diary Forms or other matters which are incomplete for further attention.
- IV. All Message Action Diary Forms shall be signed by the monitor concerned and filed in accordance with Force Orders #2274B dated 3.1.91 on Records Management.

- V. Personnel at PECC receiving emergency (119) calls should be trained in skills and techniques essential to dealing with distraught and hysterical callers. They should have the capability of obtaining accurate information in these conditions of distress to enable efficient and effective police response.
- VI. The telephone system inside PECC is designed as follows:
 - i. Emergency 119 lines which terminate at the Centre and which the public uses for emergency calls;
 - ii. General purpose lines with extensions installed for non-emergency and other administrative uses.
- VII. The emergency 119 lines shall be limited to emergency calls only so that such calls may be immediately identified and given priority attention. Therefore, the use of 119 lines for other than emergency purposes will not be encouraged. However, discretion should be used by the PECC staff when a caller is distressed or extremely upset.
- VIII. In event that non-emergency calls are received on 119 lines the PECC staff will either:
 - i. Transfer the call to a non-emergency operator who will accept the call on a non-priority basis;
 - ii. Accept the call but inform the caller that in future they use the 119 lines for emergencies only;
 - iii. Inform the caller that the 119 line is for emergency calls only and provide him/her with the appropriate seven-digit telephone number.
- IX. Speed and accuracy are essential in all emergency situations when agencies of necessity coordinate resources to deal with the existing problem. When the telephone numbers of emergency services are immediately available to communication personnel at PECC the response time can be significantly reduced. This reduction can invariably lead to the saving of lives and property. This will generate a higher degree of public confidence in the ability of the Force to handle emergencies in time of need.
- X. The Commanding Officer PECC shall be responsible to prepare a telephone listing of all emergency services in the Corporate Area, to include private lines where applicable. Copy of this list shall be prepared in booklet form and placed in the operation's booths for easy reference. The listing will be updated regularly and include the numbers of the following agencies:
 - i. Fire Department;

- ii. Jamaica Defence Force;
- iii. Correctional Services;
- iv. Office of Disaster Preparedness and Emergency Management (O.D.P.E.M);
- v. Bank of Jamaica;
- vi. Norman Manley Airport;
- vii. National Works Agency (N.W.A.);
- viii. C.B. Radio - Associates;
- ix. Security Firms;
- x. Others as appropriate and necessary.

XI. This emergency telephone number is prominently displayed in:

- i. The local telephone directory;
- ii. Public telephone booths;
- iii. On the side of marked police service vehicles;
- iv. Pamphlets prepared by the Public Relations Division;
- v. Printed and electronic media.

C. Citizen Call for Police Service

- I. Police communication of necessity requires a high degree of accuracy for the ultimate safety of police personnel and the public in general. The Assistant Commissioner of Police i/c Operations shall be responsible to prepare written directives establishing procedures for obtaining relevant information for each call for police and other emergency services. The directives shall include a checklist which shall be made available to all police radio and telephone operators island wide. The checklist shall include the following:
 - i. Type and location of incident;
 - ii. Physical description of the suspects and types of firearms if any;
 - iii. Manpower and equipment needed;
 - iv. Assistance needed from other agencies;
 - v. Transportation needs;
 - vi. Medical needs;

- vii. Need for specialist and other resource persons;
 - viii. Communication needs;
 - ix. Access to premises or building;
 - x. Plan of premises and evacuation procedure in place;
 - xi. Number of persons occupying building, description of motor vehicles used by suspects;
 - xii. Any other information which might assist in the successful conclusion of the incident;
 - xiii. Name, address and phone number of caller.
- II. The officer in charge PECC shall be responsible to ensure that directives are complied with by the entire staff at the PECC.
- III. These procedures shall also be complied with at area and divisional levels.
- IV. The operators shall be trained to elicit as much information as possible from persons who are distraught or otherwise upset.
- V. The operator shall question the caller until he/she is able to make an appreciation of the situation.
- VI. The operator, depending on the gravity of the situation, shall inform the monitor or inform the station involved, other essential services and any other interest group.
- VII. The monitor shall be responsible to keep the officer in charge abreast of all major incidents for the information of the Commissioner of Police through the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Operations.
- VIII. When the incident has been disposed of, a debriefing shall be done while the occurrence is fresh in everyone's mind. The action taken shall be discussed and constructive criticism invited to consider action needed to improve future performances.

D. Message Management

- I. Records provide the means whereby the force can store and retrieve pertinent information, deploy personnel and forecast administrative and operational needs.
- II. Whenever an individual makes a request for service, the member receiving such request shall be responsible to obtain specific information from the caller and thereafter immediately record the request on a Message Action Diary Form and in other appropriate record such as the station diary.
- III. Specific information to be obtained and recorded shall include:
 - i. Date and time of request;
 - ii. Name and address of complainant (if possible);
 - iii. Type of incident reported;
 - iv. Time of dispatch
 - v. Time of officer's return to service;
 - vi. Disposition or status of reported incident.
- IV. The operator shall affix message number on the Message Action Diary Form which has a daily numbering system. The number shall serve as the basis for filing and retrieving subsequent reports of the incidents.
- V. At the conclusion of each tour of duty, the monitor shall examine the Message Action Diary Forms and file the completed incidents.
- VI. The incomplete incidents shall be referred to the relieving monitor for follow-up action.
- VII. The monitor reporting off duty shall submit a written report including unfinished assignment for the guidance of the relieving monitor who shall be responsible to take appropriate follow up action until the conclusion of the incident.
- VIII. The Message Action Diary Form is the record on which the complaint number is affixed at the PECC. This number shall serve as the basis for filing and retrieving subsequent reports of the incidents.

- IX. It shall be the responsibility of the monitor in charge PECC to ensure that personnel performing duties of the PECC assign message number to all calls for service received during a tour of duty.
- X. When a call for service is received at the PECC the operator shall firstly affix a complaint control number on a Message Action Diary Form. Thereafter all pertinent information concerning the report shall be recorded on the form. At the conclusion of each tour of duty the operator shall hand over all Message Action Diary Forms recorded by him/her to the monitor.
- XI. After examining the forms, the monitor shall file the completed incidents and refer the incomplete ones to the relieving monitor for follow-up action.
- XII. Message Action Diary Forms shall be filed by the Monitor in conformity with a daily chronological numbering system. The numbering shall be changed every twenty four (24) hours as in Force Orders on Records Management.
- XIII. Administrative control shall be maintained on patrol personnel at all times which shall include the status of personnel when out of service.
- XIV. The Officer in charge PECC shall be responsible to the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Operations to issue written directives requiring the recording of the status of Officers when out of service.
- XV. The monitor shall be responsible to supervise the operators on duty and ensure that the written instructions are adhered to.
- XVI. Whenever a patrol is dispatched the senior member shall be responsible to inform PECC, giving the following:
 - i. Strength of party;
 - ii. Type of duty being performed;
 - iii. Zone or assigned patrol area;
 - iv. Call sign of unit;
 - v. Identity of personnel in party;

- vi. Station to which attached.
- XVII. Apart from the Message Action Diary Forms, records shall be maintained under the supervision of the Monitor as follows:
 - i. Movement Diary which records the movements of all service vehicles;
 - ii. Crime Diary which records all incidents of crime reported;
 - iii. Incident Diary which records all major incidents.
- XVIII. All patrols shall inform PECC whenever the vehicle is taken out of service, giving reasons. On resumption of the patrol, PECC shall be informed likewise.
- XIX. All movements and activities of the patrol unit shall be monitored by the operator who shall record them in the movement diary.
- XX. The Message Action Diary Forms shall be filed by the receiving monitor. They shall be utilized for the following administrative functions:
 - i. Evaluate non-patrol time for planning purposes;
 - ii. Maintain a level of security for and contact with personnel;
 - iii. Retain records of vehicles and persons stopped by members;
 - iv. Retention of Message Action Diary Sheets as a permanent record.

E. Emergency Calls

Operators at radio control room shall be trained to elicit accurate and complete information from distraught, aged, young children and all other categories of callers in emergency situations, or persons who may be unable to adequately communicate their requests for assistance.

- I. Operators shall be exceptionally knowledgeable about the geographical boundaries of the various divisions in the rural areas and the zones in the corporate area to facilitate quick police response.

- II. Where multiple services are required to handle an incident, the monitor shall be responsible to contact and co-ordinate the other services. This duty shall be performed by the duty officer or other gazetted rank as assigned by the Commissioner when necessary.
- III. Radio Operators shall be responsible to classify and prioritize calls received and shall be authorized to dispatch emergency vehicles to the given location subject to the instructions of the Monitor.
- IV. The Officer in charge PECC shall be responsible to conduct in-service training to develop the ability of operators to make speedy distinctions between emergency and non-emergency calls distinctions between emergency and nonemergency calls. Discretion must be exercised to ensure that all emergency calls are given priority attention.
- V. In order to deal with emergency situations, a standard, island-wide communication method shall be maintained which shall allow for common methods and procedures for communication within the force generally.
- VI. Training developed in communications should be available to recruits at the academy level.
- VII. It shall be the responsibility of the officer in charge PECC, subject to the approval of the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Operations to establish specific criteria for accepting and delivering emergency messages and to deal with non-emergency calls.
- VIII. In cases of non-emergency the operator shall do the following:
 - i. In the first instance the operator shall accept the call but shall politely inform the caller that in future he/she should only call 119 in cases of emergency;
 - ii. Inform the caller that 119 is for emergency purposes only. The operator shall endeavour to provide the caller with the appropriate number where he can obtain assistance;
 - iii. Transfer the call to an operator who is specially assigned to accept and process non-emergency calls;
 - iv. For persistent callers inform the individual that his problem is not an emergency one and therefore cannot be handled through 119.

- IX. It is not unusual for members of the Force to receive emergency telephone calls intended for other public services but which involve the preservation of life and property. This may be at PECC or at stations. Any such emergency call should be received and the relevant message sent to the agency involved. The following guidelines shall apply:
- i. The member answering the telephone shall obtain all relevant information from the caller in relation to the emergency. If the caller has a contact telephone number it shall be obtained and the following additional information included:
 - a) date and time of request;
 - b) name and address of caller;
 - c) date, time, type and location of the emergency.
 - ii. After obtaining the relevant information the member shall contact the agency concerned and relay the information;
 - iii. The member shall either contact the caller by telephone or assign a patrol to inform the caller that the information was relayed to the appropriate authority;
 - iv. A record shall be made in the relevant diary stating the appropriate action taken;
 - v. In the event the member is unable to contact the agency by telephone or through PECC, the supervisor or sub-officer in charge shall be immediately informed and shall be responsible to take the necessary measures to ensure that the agency involved is contacted without any further delay.

F. Recorded Communications

- I. Recording at the PECC form part of the record system of the Force. Recordings of radio transmission and emergency telephone conversations will be stored and kept for a specific period to facilitate criminal investigations, queries of citizens, departmental procedures to include personnel evaluation, training, discipline and commendations.
- II. It shall be the responsibility of the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Operations through the Deputy Commissioner of Police, Operations and Mobile Reserve to establish procedures for recording radio transmissions and emergency telephone conversations at Police Control Centre.

- III. A forty (40) channel Dictaphone 4000 Tape Recorder is installed at the PECC. This is capable of recording forty (40) radio and telephone conversations simultaneously. The officer in charge Telecommunications Division shall be responsible for its installation, maintenance, proper storage and security.
- IV. Whenever the tape is changed the technician effecting the change shall tag the completed tape showing the day, date and time of use. These tapes shall be securely stored away in chronological sequence for easy retrieval when required.
- V. Under normal circumstances the tape shall be kept in storage for three (3) months then erased and re-used. Precautionary measures shall be taken to ensure that tapes are not erased in error.
- VI. In the event a tape is required for recall purposes:
 - i. The agency or person requesting the recall makes a written request to the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Operations stating the reason for the request and the approximate date and time the conversation was held;
 - ii. In the event the request is granted, the Assistant Commissioner Of Police, Operations shall forward the request to the officer in charge PECC for attention, who shall be responsible to make all arrangements, relative to the presence of the parties involved for the tape to be replayed and the specific time agreed on;
 - iii. The officer in charge Telecommunications Division on receipt of this request shall make a technician available to facilitate the playing of the tape;
 - iv. Prior to the hearing the technician shall be responsible to locate the required conversation by means of the playback machine thus ensuring that only the required conversation is heard by the party;
 - v. The technician shall play the specified conversation to the parties as directed by the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Operations and thereafter return the tape to storage and submit a written report to his officer through the sub-officer in charge for the information of the Assistant Commissioner, Operations;
 - vi. Whenever a tape is required for court purpose a member of the Telecommunications Division shall accompany the tape;

- vii. The officer in charge Telecommunication shall be responsible to ensure that the personnel who have access to the tapes shall be familiar with the playback requirements and documentation. Care shall be exercised to ensure that tapes are not erased in error.
- VII. A person needing to summon emergency aid or report serious accident, fire, or crime etc. may be under severe emotional stress. It is essential therefore that personnel receiving such calls are specially trained to elicit initially, accurate and complete information as the caller may not be in a position to repeat the conversation.

G. External Agency Communication

- I. There are many instances during emergency situations when the expertise and assistance of other emergency services, are required to effectively deal with an existing problem. In order to expedite communication with these other services the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Operations shall be responsible to establish procedures for procuring necessary services external to the Force during such emergencies. These services include:
 - i. Fire Department;
 - ii. Hospital - ambulance;
 - iii. Jamaica Defence Force air wing and coast guards;
 - iv. Wreckers and similar services;
 - v. Taxi and other public passenger vehicles;
 - vi. National Works Agency;
 - vii. Office of Disaster Preparedness and Emergency Management.
- II. The officer in charge PECC shall be responsible to supply the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Operations with a telephone listing of all emergency service agencies in the corporate area. This listing shall include private telephone lines and radio call signs where applicable.
- III. Divisional inspectors shall be responsible to prepare a similar list at divisional level for the information of the divisional officers.
- IV. Whenever an emergency occurs which requires assistance from other agencies, the matter shall be reported by telephone or radio to the divisional officer giving such details as:

- i. Nature of emergency;
 - ii. Location;
 - iii. Type of manpower requirement;
 - iv. Assistance needed.
- V. The divisional officer shall review the situation and determine if the assistance can be obtained from the local level.
- VI. The divisional officer shall be responsible to inform the area officer and PECC of the incident, giving relevant information. If the matter requires assistance from the corporate area e.g. Jamaica Defence Force (J.D.F.) air wing, officer in charge PECC shall be requested to contact the agency concerned.
- VII. The Officer in charge PECC shall be responsible to appraise the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Operations of the emergency and the action taken in the matter. The Commissioner shall be informed by the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Operations.
- VIII. At the conclusion of the emergency the divisional officer shall submit a report on the incident through the area officer to the Commissioner.

H. Telephone Communication

- I. The Officer in charge PECC shall be responsible to the Assistant Commissioner Of Police, Operations to:
 - i. Establish procedures for routine telephone line load studies;
 - ii. Ensure that adequate telephone lines are in good working conditions to facilitate calls coming into the PECC;
 - iii. Proper supervision of personnel is maintained to ensure that calls are attended to promptly;
 - iv. Conduct weekly review of equipment and take corrective action where necessary thereby preventing callers receiving busy signals or calls not receiving attention due to faulty equipment;
 - v. Report any defects to the telephone company and take follow-up measures until the defects are remedied;
 - vi. Identify peak work load periods and determine if the equipment available is adequate to meet the demand;
 - vii. Ensure that the detail of personnel is done to accommodate peak work load periods.

I. Stolen Vehicle Information

- I. The sophistication developed by criminals in the larceny of motor vehicles represents a great challenge to members of the force and a grave financial loss to the owners. It is essential, therefore, that pertinent information be collected speedily and disseminated to all stations for immediate action. This information will also be disseminated to other local agencies such as the registry of motor vehicles.
- II. The officer in charge PECC shall be responsible to:
 - i. Issue written directives requiring daily dissemination of stolen vehicles information to all stations island-wide;
 - ii. The directive shall include procedures to be adopted in the collection and dissemination of information to other enforcement agencies and statutory bodies;
 - iii. Ensure that information concerning stolen motor vehicles shall be disseminated to all patrol and traffic personnel at least once per shift, either at briefing, or by radio or by telephone.
- III. Whenever a motor vehicle is reported stolen:
 - i. The station guard receiving the report shall obtain all relevant information from the complainant, i.e.:
 - a) name and address of registered owner;
 - b) make, model, colour, class and registration number of the motor vehicle to include the engine and chassis number;
 - c) value of motor vehicle;
 - d) brief details of the circumstances surrounding the theft;
 - e) date, time and location from which vehicle was stolen.
 - ii. The station guard shall record the report in the station diary;
 - iii. Immediately send radio message to PECC and all stations in the respective areas, concerning the theft;
 - iv. On receipt of the report the operator at PECC shall:
 - a) Complete a Message Action Diary Sheet;
 - b) Inform all units on patrol;
 - c) Dispatch island-wide all station message to include motor vehicle centre at C.I.B. Headquarters;

- d) Inform Inland Revenue giving particulars of the chassis, engine number and other relevant information;
 - e) Relay information periodically concerning stolen motor vehicles to personnel on patrol at least once per shift, either at briefing or by radio and or telephone;
 - f) Update stolen motor vehicle chart and other records.
- IV. In the event the vehicle is recovered, information shall be routed along the same channel and the stolen motor vehicle chart adjusted accordingly.

J. Charts and Maps

- I. Communications personnel are charged with the responsibility to ensure that all information emanating from the PECC is accurate in every detail and that the information is disseminated speedily.
- II. The officer in charge PECC Hq and for Areas I, II and III shall be responsible to ensure that large detailed street maps are prominently displayed in the Radio Control Centre under their respective commands with the following:
 - i. Area I - Amber;
 - ii. Area II - Red;
 - iii. Area III - Green;
 - iv. Area IV - Yellow;
 - v. Area V - Yellow.

The corporate area map shall also be divided into patrol zones to facilitate supervision and monitoring of patrol personnel.

- III. The officer in charge PECC shall be responsible to ensure that the maps detailing the force's service area are placed in such a strategic position that they are visually available to all personnel in the centre. Beats and radio car patrol zones shall be clearly outlined thus enabling personnel to readily identify a caller's location and dispatch radio cars and other units to the area without any undue delay. PECC shall be equipped with a status board and maps to indicate the current location and status of all police radio units, on patrol or otherwise assigned for safety and supervisory purposes.

- IV. Duty status indicators are important to the operator at PECC as it allows for the proper monitoring of personnel on duty on assignment. It enables the operator to know where and for what period of time a member or team has been out on a particular call. This will invariably assist the operator to determine whether or not a member may be in personal danger and in need of assistance. In these respects, the PECC shall be equipped with status boards and maps to indicate the current status of all police units on patrol.

K. Duty Assignments

- I. The duty status indicators shall be visually available to all communication personnel at PECC.
- II. All vehicles commencing patrol or other related duties shall supply PECC with the following information:
 - i. Strength of party;
 - ii. Call sign - make of vehicle;
 - iii. Type of duty;
 - iv. Patrol zone;
 - v. Name of person in charge.
- III. It shall be the responsibility of the operator at PECC on receipt of such report to record the information on the Message Action Diary at PECC. The operator shall thereafter update the map and status board to indicate the zone in which that vehicle is operating. The following are colour codes which shall be used:
 - i. Red - assigned;
 - ii. Green - not assigned;
 - iii. Yellow - out of unit or on recreation break.
- IV. The driver of the service vehicle shall report to PECC:
 - i. When the party is out of the unit giving location and reason;
 - ii. When the party resumes patrol;

- iii. Whenever the party concludes duty.
- V. The Operator at PECC shall be responsible to complete the Message Action Diary Form and adjust the status board and maps accordingly.
- VI. At the conclusion of duty, the operator shall be responsible to submit all the Message Action Diary Forms to the monitor for information and appropriate action.
- VII. On receipt of the forms the monitor shall be responsible to check the forms and to ascertain if the assignment is completed.
- VIII. If the assignment is incomplete he shall return the form to the relieving operator to complete the assignment.
- IX. On completion of the assignment the monitor shall sign the forms and cause same to be filed for future reference.
- X. All Message Action Diary Forms shall be numbered chronologically on a daily basis and filed accordingly.

L. Back-Up Assignments

- I. It is sometimes necessary to assign back-up personnel to assist on-scene personnel thereby providing sufficient manpower to deal with the existing problem. This action also enhances the security of the member primarily assigned to the duty (primary officer), and also to prevent the situation becoming uncontrollable.
- II. There are two (2) generally accepted methods of recording information relative to back-up personnel:
 - i. Preparing a Message Action Diary Sheet for the on-scene personnel and including the particulars of the members used as back-up; or
 - ii. Preparing a separate Message Action Sheet for the back-up party assigned, using the same number as the member who was given the original assignment.

- III. The Monitor at PECC shall be responsible to ensure that a record is made on the Message Action Diary Form and in the movement diary whenever a back-up personnel is assigned to assist other personnel on duty. Particulars of the back-up personnel can either be recorded on the original sheet or a new sheet prepared bearing the same number as the original dispatch.
- IV. The monitor shall be responsible to ensure that both entries are made, using either format as the situation dictates.

M. Private Alarms

- I. Many private agencies including banks are authorized by the Commissioner to install private alarm systems with linkages at the PECC and other police stations throughout the island. A log book is kept at the PECC of all such systems.
- II. The two systems currently being used are:
 - i. Digital Display - a number appears on a screen, which is checked by the operator to verify the identity of the owner;
 - ii. Telephone Recorder - when the alarm is activated a recorded message is received on the telephone, giving the identity and location of the premises.
- III. The role of the force in responding to and monitoring private security shall be:
 - i. To expedite response time;
 - ii. To keep an up-to-date record of firms utilizing private security system;
 - iii. To communicate with owners/managers after an alarm is dealt with by the police to ascertain if adequate action was taken in the matter and to obtain suggestions for improvement in relation to future police action.
- IV. On receiving a message at PECC, the operator shall be responsible to record the message on the Message Action Diary Form. He/she shall immediately alert and assign a particular unit to answer the call. The divisional officer or station involved shall also be informed.

- V. After assigning the unit, follow-up action shall be taken to ensure that too many units do not converge on the location, and that the units so detailed are strategically placed to maximize effectiveness.
- VI. Particulars of C.I.B. personnel shall be relayed to units by PECC for identification purposes.
- VII. At the conclusion of the exercise, the supervisor of the party shall be responsible to inform PECC of the outcome of the exercise, including arrests made, if any.
- VIII. The operator at PECC shall be responsible to inform the monitor and control officer immediately of any major incidents reported through the private security system for the information of the Assistant Commissioner, Operations and the Commissioner.

N. Dispatching Plans

- I. One of the primary functions of the police is to protect the lives and properties of the citizenry. When a crime is in progress, the time taken by the police to respond to the call is often the determinant between life and death, and whether or not the culprits are apprehended.
- II. Area, divisional and section commanders shall be responsible to prepare tactical plans (operational orders) to deal with these situations, in the event they occur within their command.
- III. Whenever an unexpected major incident, planned major incidents or serious crimes occur, it shall be the responsibility of the Commander to ensure that communication personnel have immediate access to tactical dispatching plans, relative to the particular event.
- IV. The report to PECC shall include procedures to be followed in:
 - i. Directing resources;
 - ii. Obtaining information on the given situation, e.g. crime in progress, major incident;
 - iii. Proposed tactical operations.

- V. Area, divisional and section commanders shall be responsible to prepare operational orders for serious crimes and incidents frequently occurring or likely to occur in their respective commands. These operational orders shall be reviewed periodically to ensure that they can adequately meet the demands when required.
- VI. The operational order shall include the preparation of an inventory showing potential crime hazards such as banks, supermarkets, liquor stores, etc. It shall also include names and telephone numbers of the owners/managers.
- VII. A map of the area surrounding each building shall be prepared, showing roadways, position and number of doors in the particular building, likely escape routes, time of day the crime is likely to occur, traffic conditions or any other information that will assist to contain the culprits should the situation arise.
- VIII. On receiving such message at PECC the operator shall be responsible to immediately alert units and divisions that are likely to be involved in the action.
- IX. The operator will obtain as much information from the caller as possible to include the address and the exact location within the building that the crime is being committed. The operator shall obtain as much descriptive data about the suspects as possible including the number of suspects, distinctive clothing, weapons, vehicles and the description of any individual who might be taken as hostage by the criminals. The unit closest to the scene shall be assigned to handle the call until the arrival of a senior person to take command of the situation.
- X. The operator shall inform regular personnel of the presence of detectives and their means of identity to ensure that they are not mistaken for the criminals. Where practicable the detectives shall wear the vest with the word "Police" emblazoned on the back and front to ensure easy identification.
- XI. Supervisors of tactical teams shall be responsible to inform PECC of their tactical dispatching plans for road blocks, etc. prior to departure from the situation. The information shall include strength of party, identity of supervisor including rank, call sign of the units, equipment to be used, and location of the road block. This is essential to enable the radio operator to be aware of the location and status of the personnel and equipment engaged in the operation.

- XII. At the completion of the assignment, the supervisor shall be responsible to update PECC on all aspect of the operation for the information of the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Operations and to complete the records at the PECC.

O. Duty Roster

In times of major incidents and emergencies it is necessary to establish immediate contact with specialist and technical personnel. It shall be the responsibility of the officer in charge PECC, area, divisional and section commanders to ensure that communication personnel have immediate access to at least the following:

- i. Officer in charge specialist or technical functions;
- ii. Duty roster of all personnel;
- iii. Address and telephone numbers of all emergency personnel.

- I. The Officer in charge PECC shall be responsible to maintain:

- i. An up-to-date listing of the names, addresses and telephone numbers of all gazetted officers;
- ii. An up-to-date listing of the names, ranks, addresses and telephone numbers of all personnel attached to the PECC.

- II. Area, divisional and section commanders shall be responsible to maintain similar lists of all personnel under their commands. These lists shall include the addresses and telephone numbers of the respective commanders.

- III. All duty rosters shall be updated on a daily basis and shall be immediately available to PECC personnel, in the event it is required.

P. Technical Equipment Management

- I. The Assistant Commissioner of Police, Technology Branch is responsible for the maintenance and management of equipment in the force's communication programme; and is responsible for the training of users in their use, handling and care. This will also include:
- i. Simplified instructions for use of equipment where necessary;

- ii. Other instructions necessary for the management of technical equipment designed to enhance the efficiency of the force.

9. Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

This policy and standard operating procedure on the management of communication shall be read in conjunction with the following:

- A. Police Code of Conduct
- B. Police Public Interaction Policy

10.Relevant Records and Forms

- A. Station Diary
- B. PECC Log Book
- C. Message Action Diary Form
- D. Movement Diary

11.Roles and Functions

- A. The Officer in charge of PECC and Telecom will ensure the accuracy, dependability, speed and confidentiality of electronic communications at all levels. Each will manage his formation so that each member of staff will:
 - i. Contribute effectively to the standardization of services rendered;
 - ii. Reduction of errors;
 - iii. Aid the training effort;
 - iv. Reduce confusion during emergency situations.

Appendix 1

MESSAGE ACTION DIARY

P REQUEST	PRIORITY: 1 ☐ EMERGENCY/DISASTER 2 ☐ URGENT/IMMEDIATE	3 ☐ NEXT AVAILABLE UNIT 4 ☐ FOUND/OBSERVATION	5 ☐ INTERNAL 6 ☐ HISTORICAL			
1. Station: _____ Date : _____ Message No. _____						
From	Received	Name	Phone	Address	Time	How
2 2. CLASS: _____ _____ 3. MESSAGE: _____ _____ _____ _____						

4. Message Out:- Outward By Radio	Call Signs	Time Dispatch	Location of Patrol Car	Time Arr.
5. Message Outward	Stations	Time	Rank and No. of Person Informed	

By Phone					
REPORTS FROM RADIO PAROLS AND STATIONS			HOW	STATION	TIME

Operator's No.

6.	REPORTS FROM RADIO PATROLS AND STATIONS	HOW	STATION	TIME

Investigating Officer

Name	Rank	No.	Station
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Remarks and Results

N.B. Always use ink pen on all sections

S. O. i/c Operations

- STATUS ☐ CL- Closed
☐ CU- Closed Undetected
- OF ☐ NF- No Further Police Act
☐ NT- Not True Case
☐ OI- Open Under Invest
- REPORT ☐ OT- Open- Pending Trial
☐ TC-Taken into Consideration
☐ CC- Closed Caution